

Collects and Biographies for

# **Saints' Days & Festivals**

of the Scottish Episcopal Calendar

*February*

## Using this booklet

This booklet contains a short biography, and appropriate collects, for all saints and dated festivals within the Scottish Calendar published in 1996. It does not provide Post-Communion Prayers.

You may use the short biography as a preface to the Collect of the Day to introduce the life of the saint to the congregation, or as a short homily.

This booklet is arranged with one saint (or festival) to a page, giving details of the saint's day, its category (1-6) and the liturgical colour. Collects for use at a 1970 Scottish Liturgy (or 1929) Eucharist are given on the left, those for 1982 Scottish Liturgy on the right.

## Notes

- Where feasts in Category 4 fall on a Sunday (other than a Sunday in Categories 1 and 2), they may, if local circumstances require, be kept on that day.
- When days in Category 6 coincide with a day of higher category, they should be omitted that year.

## Key to Abbreviations

|       |                                                          |
|-------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| ASB   | Alternative Service Book 1980 (Church of England)        |
| CCP   | Celebrating Common Prayer (Society of St Francis)        |
| ECUSA | Episcopal Church of the United States of America         |
| EH    | Exciting Holiness, 2003                                  |
| LFF   | The proper for the Lesser Feasts and Fasts, 1991 (ECUSA) |
| MEG   | Malcolm E. Grant, The Revd. Canon                        |
| R     | The Roman Missal (1970)                                  |
| SEC   | Scottish Episcopal Church Alternative Collects           |
| SPB   | Scottish Prayer Book 1929                                |
| SPCK  | Society for the Promotion of Christian Knowledge         |

## Credits

Originally compiled by the Reverend Canon Malcolm E. Grant, and used at the Cathedral of St Andrew, Inverness. This version was edited and repaginated by the Reverend Gareth J. M. Saunders, Edinburgh, June – October 2003. Additional material was taken from *Exciting Holiness*, Second Edition, 2003.

Version 2.02

## **1 FEBRUARY**

### **Bride of Kildare, Abbess (c.525) [6] White**

Brigid, or Bride, honoured in Ireland as 'Mary of the Gael', was born around the middle of the 5th century, and founded the first women's religious community in Ireland at Kildare, which she ruled as abbess for many years, giving her a unique position in the Irish Church. She worked with Bishop Conleth in preaching the Gospel, and the accounts of her life give an impression of a strong, happy and compassionate character, imbued with shining charity. She died at Kildare, around the year 525.

#### **1970 Scottish Liturgy**

Almighty God,  
by whose grace thy servant Bride,  
kindled with the fire of thy love,  
became a burning and a shining light  
in thy church in Ireland:  
in flame us, we pray thee,  
with the same spirit  
of discipline and love,  
that we may ever walk before thee  
as children of light;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(ASB – adapted)*

#### **1982 Scottish Liturgy**

Lord,  
you inspired Saint Bride  
with such whole-hearted  
dedication to your work  
that she is known as  
Mary of the Gael:  
may we follow  
the example of her life,  
and be united with her  
and the Virgin Mary  
in your presence;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(R – adapted)*

## 2 FEBRUARY

### THE PRESENTATION OF THE LORD [2] *White*

This day marks the completion of forty days since the birth of Jesus, when Mary and Joseph took the child to the Temple in Jerusalem. The requirement in Levitical law was for Mary to be ‘cleansed’, the completion of her purification following the birth of a male child. Until the day, she could touch no holy thing nor enter the sanctuary. Yet on seeing the holy family, Simeon praised God and acclaimed the infant as ‘the light to enlighten the nations’ and the prophet Anna gave thanks and proclaimed him her Redeemer. The image of Christ as the Light has led to the celebration of light countering darkness, with candles often taking a central place in the observance of this festival.

*(Exciting Holiness (2003), p.81)*

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and Everliving God,  
we humbly beseech thy Majesty,  
that, as thy only-begotten Son  
was this day presented in the temple  
in substance of our flesh,  
so we may be presented unto thee  
with pure and clean hearts;  
by the same thy Son  
Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(SPB)*

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and ever-living God,  
clothed in majesty,  
whose beloved Son  
was this day presented in the  
Temple  
in the substance of our mortal  
nature:  
may we be presented to you  
with pure and clean hearts,  
by your Son Jesus Christ our Lord,  
who is alive and reigns with you,  
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,  
one God, now and for ever.

*(SEC)*

#### Note

*The Presentation of the Lord* may be observed on the Sunday nearest to 2 February.

### 3 FEBRUARY

#### Saints and Martyrs of Europe [6] *Red*

In the Acts of the Apostles it is related how Paul, accompanied by Barnabas and Luke, crossed the Dardanelles from Asia, and first brought the good new of Jesus Christ into Europe. Paul's extensive journeys, to which his Letters bear witness, laid the foundation of the Church in Greece. He and others, including Peter, preached the gospel in Rome before the first persecutions began under Nero. In the following centuries many martyrs and missionaries spread the gospel message over the Roman Empire, and after the fall of Rome to the barbarians who occupied its lands. In turn they took their new-found faith to their pagan kin in northern and eastern Europe. Since then, the Church in Europe has not lacked faithful people in every age who have continued to proclaim the kingdom of God to all who have eyes to see and ears to hear.

*(Exciting Holiness (2003), p.87f.)*

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Lord God,  
who by the faithful witness  
and labours of thy servants  
since the earliest days of thy Church  
has claimed the continent of Europe  
for thine own service:  
grant that, as by thy mercy  
we have entered into  
so rich a heritage,  
so by thy grace we may labour  
to preserve and strengthen it  
by loving service  
and willing sacrifice;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(MEG, from South African PB)*

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

Draw your Church together, O God,  
into one great company of disciples,  
together following our Lord  
Jesus Christ into every walk of life,  
together serving him  
in his mission to the world,  
and together witnessing to his love  
on every continent and island;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(EH)*

## 6 FEBRUARY

### Paul Miki, and the Martyrs of Japan (1597) [6] *Red*

Born in Japan around 1565, Paul Miki entered the Jesuit Order and preached the Gospel with considerable success, but when persecution arose, sparked off partly by fears of European influence, he and twenty-five others were seized and subjected to terrible tortures before being crucified in Nagasaki in 1597. After their martyrdom, their bloodied clothes were kept and held in reverence by their fellow Christians. The period of persecution continued for another thirty-five years, many new witness-martyrs being added to their number.

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God our Father,  
who art the source of strength  
for all thy saints,  
and who didst bring Paul Miki  
and the holy martyrs of Japan  
through the suffering of the cross  
to the joys of life eternal:  
grant that we, being encouraged  
by their example,  
may hold fast the faith we profess,  
even unto death;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.  
(ECUSA – LFF)

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

God our Father,  
source of strength for all your saints,  
you led Paul Miki  
and his companions  
through the suffering of the cross  
to the joy of eternal life:  
may their example and their prayers  
give us the courage  
to be loyal in professing our faith  
until death;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.  
(R – *adapted*)

**10 FEBRUARY**  
**Scholastica, Religious (543) [6] *White***

Scholastica was the sister of Saint Benedict, born at Nursia in Umbria, Central Italy, around the year AD 480. Together with her brother she consecrated herself to God, and when Benedict moved to Monte Cassino she settled at Plombariola nearby, joining or maybe founding a nunnery under his direction. As abbess she sought to follow Benedict's Rule, and met him once a year at a house near his monastery where they would praise God together and discuss spiritual matters, Benedict often seeking his sister's advice. She died about the year 543. Benedict had a vision of her soul rising up to heaven and, collecting her body, he had her buried in a tomb prepared for himself. Scholastica soon became a figure for veneration by all nuns who followed Benedict's Rule.

**1970 Scottish Liturgy**

O God our Father,  
who rejoicest in the devotion  
of thy humble servants:  
grant that by thy grace  
we may follow the example  
of Scholastica  
and serve thee with love  
here on earth  
and obtain thy perfect joy hereafter;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.  
*(MEG, from R)*

**1982 Scottish Liturgy**

Lord, as we recall the memory  
of Saint Scholastica,  
we ask that by her example  
we may serve you  
with an untarnished love  
and obtain your perfect joy;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.  
*(R – adapted)*

## 14 FEBRUARY

### Cyril, Monk (869) and Methodius, Bishop (885) [6] *White*

Cyril was born in Thessalonica around the year AD 827, and taught in the imperial university at Constantinople. His elder brother, Methodius, was governor of an imperial province. They were ordained priests, and sent as missionaries to Moravia, where they translated the Bible and liturgical books in the Slavonic language, using the Cyrillic alphabet, which they invented. They were called to Rome, where Cyril died in 869.

Methodius was consecrated bishop and sent back to his mission in Moravia and modern Hungary, where he endured many hardships as the result of jealousy, despite the support of the Holy See for his Slavonic mission. He died in 885.

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

Father,  
who didst bring  
the light of the Gospel  
to the Slavic nations  
through Saint Cyril  
and his brother Saint Methodius;  
open our hearts, we pray thee,  
to understand what thou dost teach,  
and unite us all in faith and praise;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(R – adapted)*

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

Father,  
you brought  
the light of the Gospel  
to the Slavic nations  
through Saint Cyril  
and his brother Saint Methodius;  
open our hearts  
to understand your teaching  
and help us to become  
one in faith and praise;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(R)*



## 15 FEBRUARY

### Thomas Bray, Priest and Missionary (1730) [6] *White*

A native of Shropshire, Thomas Bray was selected to go to Maryland as commissary for the Bishop of London. While his departure was delayed, he drew up a scheme for the provision of free libraries in the colony. This and similar schemes in England led to his founding the *Society for Promoting Christian Knowledge* (SPCK) in 1689, and 3 years later a separate organization for overseas work, the *Society for the Propagation of the Gospel* (SPG).

After a short time in America, where his concern for the Christian education of the young bore much fruit, he returned to England to promote the work of these two societies. He campaigned widely for the consecration of a bishop for America, but failed; he also showed a deep concern for native Americans and for black slaves, and worked for prison reform. He died in 1730.

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God,  
who didst inspire  
thy servant Thomas Bray  
to labour for the spread  
of the Gospel  
and for the increase of wisdom  
and sound learning:  
prosper, we beseech thee,  
the labours of all Christian writers  
and translators,  
and all who distribute  
Christian literature,  
to the advancement  
of the knowledge of thy love  
among the nations,  
and the building up of thy Church  
in every land;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPCK – adapted)

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

God,  
you moved Thomas Bray to labour  
for the spread of the Gospel  
and the increase of wisdom  
and sound learning:  
prosper with your blessing  
the work of all Christian  
writers and translators  
and all who distribute Christian  
literature,  
so that the knowledge of your love  
may spread among the nations  
and your Church be built up  
in every land;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPCK – adapted)

**17 FEBRUARY**  
**Finan of Lindisfarne, Bishop (661) [6] *White***

Finan, an Irish monk of Iona, succeeded Aiden as Bishop of Lindisfarne, and carried his missionary work south of the Humber. Among his converts were Peada, King of the Middle Angles, son of the obstinately heathen King Penda; and Sigebert, King of the East Saxons. He vigorously and consistently upheld the Celtic ecclesiastical traditions against those coming from the south who followed the Roman usage. He died in AD 661.

**1970 Scottish Liturgy**

O God,  
who through the preaching  
of blessed Finan  
didst carry the light of the gospel  
deep into the darkness  
of these islands:  
raise up, we pray thee,  
prophets and preachers  
who may proclaim  
the good news of thy love  
by word and by example,  
and draw many to that service  
which is perfect freedom;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

**1982 Scottish Liturgy**

Heavenly Father,  
by the preaching  
of your holy servant Finan  
the light of the gospel  
was carried deep into the darkness  
of these islands:  
raise up, we pray,  
prophets and preachers  
to proclaim the good news  
of your love  
by word and example,  
and to draw many to that service  
which is perfect freedom;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

**18 FEBRUARY**  
**Colman of Lindisfarne, Bishop (676) [6] *White***

Colman, an Irish monk from Iona, succeeded Finan as Bishop of Lindisfarne at a critical time in the disagreement between the Celtic and Roman traditions about the date of Easter and other customs. He supported the Celtic usages, but at the Synod of Whitby, the Northumbrian King was persuaded by Wilfred's arguments for the Roman case, and accepted it. Colman resigned his bishopric and retired to Iona and from there to Ireland, where he died on this day in the year 676.

Bede gives a glowing account of the Church of Lindisfarne under Colman's episcopate, emphasising the bishop's example of frugality and simplicity of life, and the complete devotion of the bishop and his monks to the work of teaching the Word of God and ministering to His people.

**1970 Scottish Liturgy**

O God,  
who through thy blessed bishop  
Colman  
didst commend the virtues  
of frugal living and apostolic zeal  
to his brethren and his flock:  
renew within the pastors  
of thy Church  
compassion for all people,  
and enkindle in them  
the fire of thy Word,  
that they may draw many  
to righteousness of life in thy service;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

**1982 Scottish Liturgy**

God our Father,  
through your holy bishop Colman  
you commended the virtues  
of frugal living and apostolic zeal  
to his brethren and his flock:  
inspire the pastors of your Church  
with compassion for all people,  
and kindle in them  
the fire of your Word,  
that they may draw many  
to righteous living in your service;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

## 19 FEBRUARY

### **Martin Luther, Reformer (1545) [6] *White***

Born a miner's son in Saxony in 1483, Martin Luther entered the Augustinian monastery at Erfurt, and was sent three years later as a lecturer to the newly-founded University of Wittenberg, where he became Professor of Scripture, a post he held until his death in 1546.

His teaching began to diverge from mediaeval orthodoxy, and his own disposition caused him great anxiety about his own salvation. A sudden revelation convinced him that the essence of the Gospel was that faith alone justifies, and this became the cornerstone of his teaching. In 1517 he drew up his famous 95 theses against Indulgencies, and in 1520 was excommunicated by the Pope. His ideas spread rapidly through Germany, encouraged in many states by the secular rulers, and the rest of his life was spent in writing treatises expounding his theology, often with profound religious feeling.

#### **1970 Scottish Liturgy**

Grant us, O God,  
such a vision of thy glory and truth,  
that we may recognize  
in thy Church on earth  
a constant need  
for renewal and reform,  
and grant us,  
after the example of Martin Luther,  
grace and courage  
to work tirelessly and fearlessly  
to accomplish it;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

#### **1982 Scottish Liturgy**

Grant us, O God,  
such a vision of your glory and truth,  
that we may recognize  
in your Church on earth  
a constant need  
for renewal and reform,  
and grant and courage  
that we may follow  
the example of Martin Luther,  
in working tirelessly  
and fearlessly to accomplish it;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

## 23 FEBRUARY

### Polycarp of Smyrna, Bishop and Martyr (156) [6] *Red*

Polycarp was a disciple of the apostle John, and an important Christian figure in Asia Minor, where he was Bishop of Smyrna. A staunch defender of orthodoxy, he vigorously combated the heresies of his age.

He went to Rome to confer with Bishop Anicetus over the date of Easter, but soon after his return to Smyrna he was betrayed and taken before the proconsul at the pagan games. Urged to renounce his religion he replied "86 years I have served Him, and He never did me any wrong. How can I blaspheme my King who saved me?" The order was then given for him to be burnt alive, the year was 156. An account of his trial and martyrdom survives.

#### 1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,  
who gavest to thy servant  
Polycarp  
boldness to confess the Name  
of our Saviour Jesus Christ  
before the rulers of this world,  
and courage to die for this faith:  
grant, we beseech thee,  
that we also may be ready  
to give an account  
of the faith that is in us,  
and to suffer gladly  
for the sake of our Lord Jesus Christ,  
who now liveth and reigneth  
with thee and the Holy Spirit,  
one God in glory everlasting.

*(CCP – adapted)*

#### 1982 Scottish Liturgy

God of all creation,  
you gave your bishop Polycarp  
the privilege of being counted  
among the saints  
who gave their lives  
in faithful witness of the Gospel:  
may his example give us  
the courage to share with him  
the cup of suffering  
and so be raised to eternal glory;  
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

*(R – adapted)*





# February

|    |                                                                          |   |              |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|--------------|
| 1  | Bride of Kildare, Abbess, c.525                                          | 6 | White        |
| 2  | <b>THE PRESENTATION OF THE LORD</b>                                      | 2 | <b>White</b> |
| 3  | Saints and Martyrs of Europe                                             | 6 | Red          |
| 4  | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 5  | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 6  | Paul Miki, Priest, and the Martyrs of Japan, 1597                        | 6 | Red          |
| 7  | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 8  | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 9  | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 10 | Scholastica, Religious, 543                                              | 6 | White        |
| 11 | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 12 | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 13 | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 14 | Cyril, Monk, 869, and Methodius, Bishop, 885,<br>"Apostles of the Slavs" | 6 | White        |
| 15 | Thomas Bray, Priest and Missionary, 1730                                 | 6 | White        |
| 16 | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 17 | Finan of Lindisfarne, Bishop, 661                                        | 6 | White        |
| 18 | Colman of Lindisfarne, Bishop, 676                                       | 6 | White        |
| 19 | Martin Luther, 1545                                                      | 6 | White        |
| 20 | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 21 | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 22 | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 23 | Polycarp of Smyrna, Bishop and Martyr, 156                               | 6 | Red          |
| 24 | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 25 | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 26 | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 27 | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 28 | —                                                                        | — | —            |
| 29 | —                                                                        | — | —            |